

Junyoung Kim

 [junieberry.github.io](https://github.com/junieberry) |  [junieberry](https://github.com/junieberry) |  [in in/junieberry](https://in.linkedin.com/in/junieberry) |  [Google Scholar](https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=...)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research explores how AI systems can **understand and act on human intentions** expressed through language, ultimately enhancing human-AI interaction.

- **Modeling Human Intent and Preference** [A1, A4, A5]: Understanding implicit intentions and contextual goals in natural language to align system interpretation with human expression.
- **Human-centered Evaluation** [A3]: Evaluation frameworks that move beyond static ground truths to capture user satisfaction, adaptability, and alignment with diverse human values.

EDUCATION

University of Toronto

Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

Graduate Visiting Student, (GPA: 4.0/4.0)

Awarded a fellowship by the Ministry of Science and ICT

Sungkyunkwan University (GPA: 4.36/4.5)

Sep 2023 – Aug 2025

M.S. in Artificial Intelligence

Sungkyunkwan University

Mar 2019 – Aug 2023

B.S. in Computer Education, (GPA: 4.17/4.5), *Magna Cum Laude*

PUBLICATIONS

*: *Equal contribution.*

International Conferences

- [A1] **Bayesian Active Learning with Gaussian Processes Guided by LLM Relevance Scoring for Dense Passage Retrieval** |  

Junyoung Kim, Anton Korikov, Jiazhou Liang, Justin Cui, Yifan Liu, Qianfeng Wen, Mark Zhao, Scott Sanner

The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), Findings, 2026

- [A2] **Multimodal Item Scoring for Natural Language Recommendation via Gaussian Process Regression with LLM Relevance Judgments** | 

Yifan Liu, Qianfeng Wen, Jiazhou Liang, Mark Zhao, Justin Cui, Anton Korikov, Armin Toroghi, Junyoung Kim, Scott Sanner

The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), Findings, 2026

- [A3] **Transparent Reference-free Automated Evaluation of Open-Ended User Survey Responses** | 

Subin An*, Yugyeong Ji*, Junyoung Kim*, Heejin Kook*, Yang Lu, Josh Seltzer

Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), Industry Track, 2025

- [A4] **Empowering Retrieval-based Conversational Recommendation with Contrasting User Preferences** |  

Heejin Kook*, Junyoung Kim*, Sungmin Park, Jongwuk Lee

North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL), 2025

- [A5] **MARS: Matching Attribute-aware Representations for Text-based Sequential Recommendation** |  

Hyunsoo Kim*, Junyoung Kim*, Minjin Choi, Sunkyoung Lee, Jongwuk Lee

Conference on Information and Knowledge Management (CIKM), Short Paper, 2024

Domestic Conferences & Journals

- [B1] **An Inference Framework for Text-Based Sequential Recommendation Model Using Nearest Neighbor Mechanism**

Junyoung Kim, Hyunsoo Kim, Jongwuk Lee

Journal of KIISE, 2025

- [B2] **A Deep Analysis of the Unified Recommender Model Using Pre-trained Language Models and Suggestions for Improvement**

Junyoung Kim*, Hyunsoo Kim*, Jongwuk Lee

[B3] **A Deep Analysis of the Unified Recommender Model using Pre-trained Language Models**

Junyoung Kim*, Hyunsoo Kim*, Jongwuk Lee

Korea Software Congress (KSC), 2022 [Best Presentation]

EXPERIENCES

Naver Corp.

Jul 2026 – Oct 2026

AI Engineering Intern

- Developed a self-improving LLM-as-a-Judge system for search-data annotation.
- Developed an LLM-based system for translating natural-language label modification requests into executable code.

Angle Company

Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

AI Research Intern

- Developed handwriting separation and preprocessing methods for OCR on insurance documents.

Data-Driven Decision-Making (D3M) Lab, University of Toronto

Jan 2025 – Aug 2025

Research Assistant, advised by Prof. Scott Sanner

- Led research on cost-aware document relevance modeling under LLM inference constraints, improving Recall@50 by up to 42.22% over existing methods [A1].
- Contributed to research on LLM-based relevance modeling for natural-language recommendation [A2].

Nexxt Intelligence

Jan 2025 – Jul 2025

Student Researcher (Industry-Academia Collaboration, Ministry of Science and ICT)

- Developed an LLM-as-a-Judge framework for evaluating open-ended survey responses, achieving up to 0.8614 Spearman correlation with human experts [A3].

Data Intelligence and Learning (DIAL) Lab, Sungkyunkwan University

Apr 2022 – Jan 2025

Research Assistant, advised by Prof. Jongwuk Lee

- Led research on LLM-based conversational recommendation with contrastive user preference modeling, improving Recall@10 by up to 99.72% over existing models [A4].
- Led research on attribute-aware text-based sequential recommendation, improving NDCG@10 by up to 29.26% (13%+ in zero-shot settings) over existing methods [A5].

AWARDS

2nd, 4th Prize (Ministerial Award), 6th AI Grand Challenge

2023

Developed a multimodal RAG system for policy decision support

3rd Prize, 4th AI x BOOKATHON (AI Writing Contest) 🏆

2023

Keyword-driven essay generator that maintains a consistent plot across long context

Best Presentation Award, Korea Software Congress

2022

1st Prize, SKKU AI-Education Hackathon 🏆 🖥️

2022

Visual analytics system to assist peer learning based on source code

2nd Prize, SKKU AI-Education Hackathon 🏆

2021

Korean narrative quiz generator based on word embedding

SCHOLARSHIP

SKKU AI Graduate Student Research Grant

2023, 2024

SKKU Academic Excellence Scholarship

2022, 2023

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant

Database Project

2024 Fall

Introduction to Database

2024 Spring

Fundamentals of Machine Learning

2023 Fall